4. Starting a fire safely (English)

Oracle OS guide (SurvivalManual / US Army FM 21-76 in the library).

Before lighting

Sheltered from wind, **away from trees, dry brush, roofs and tents**; clear a 3 m circle to bare soil; stone ring (avoid river stones — they can burst). Respect fire bans. Keep water, soil or sand ready.

Gather everything first

1. **Tinder** (catches a spark): cotton with petroleum jelly, paper, birch bark, dry grass, feather sticks, dryer lint, fine steel wool.
2. **Kindling**: dry sticks from match-thick to finger-thick (dead branches still on trees are drier).
3. **Fuel**: wrist-thick and bigger. Split wet wood — the inside is often dry.

Lays

Teepee (fast, cooking), log cabin (steady, good coals), star (push logs in as they burn; saves wood).

Ignition

Matches in a waterproof jar, lighter, **ferro rod** (scrape hard close to the tinder), **9 V battery + fine steel wool**, magnifying lens in sun, friction bow drill (practise first). **Never** use petrol.

Put it out

Spread embers, drown with water, stir, drown again until cool to the back of your hand.

Indoors

Only in a sound fireplace or wood stove. Never charcoal or camping stoves inside. Smoke and CO alarms.